ManageEngine Endpoint Central Deployment Report

Using Windows 11 Host with Kali & Ubuntu Virtual Machines

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1. Objective

The purpose of this project was to set up ManageEngine Desktop Central (now Endpoint Central) on a Windows 11 host machine, and to deploy the Desktop Central agent on virtual client systems (Kali Linux and Ubuntu). This enables centralized endpoint management, inventory collection, and policy enforcement.

2. Installation of Endpoint Central Server

- Downloaded the trial version of ManageEngine Endpoint Central from the official website.
- Installed on the Windows 11 host PC.
- Configured to run on default ports:
  - 8020 (agent communication)
  - 8383 (web console – HTTPS).
- Accessed the console via browser at:
  https://192.168.56.1:8383

3. Network Configuration

- VM network adapters were set to Bridged Adapter so they shared the same subnet as the host.
- On Windows 11, firewall rules were added to allow inbound connections on ports 8020 and 8383.
- Connectivity tested with ping and telnet from VMs to the host IP.

4. Agent Deployment on Linux VMs

Kali Linux VM

1. Downloaded Linux agent package from Endpoint Central.
2. File obtained: UEMS_LinuxAgent.bin.
3. Installed with:
   chmod +x UEMS_LinuxAgent.bin
   sudo ./UEMS_LinuxAgent.bin
4. Entered server details:
   - Server IP: Windows 11 host IP
   - Port: 8020
   - Protocol: HTTPS.
5. Verified agent was running:
   ps aux | grep UEMS

Ubuntu VM

1. Repeated same steps as Kali.
2. After installation, Ubuntu agent connected to Endpoint Central successfully.

5. Verification of Deployment

- Both Kali Linux and Ubuntu appeared as Managed Computers in the console.
- Inventory was reported:
  - OS version
  - Hardware specs (CPU, RAM, disk)
  - Installed software packages.

6. Challenges Faced

- Connection Timed Out: Initially, the Linux VMs could not reach the host server because they were configured with NAT networking. Resolved by switching to Bridged Adapter mode.
- Firewall Blocking: Windows Firewall initially blocked port 8020. Added rules to allow agent communication.
- Hotspot Limitation: When testing with Android hotspot, loopback traffic was restricted, preventing device enrollment.
- No Available Patches: The Endpoint Central server did not display any available patches initially, making it difficult to validate patch management. Required further troubleshooting and verification.

7. Conclusion

The project successfully demonstrated the setup of ManageEngine Endpoint Central on a Windows 11 host and the deployment of agents to Linux VMs (Kali and Ubuntu). The machines reported inventory back to the console and appeared as managed devices.

This lays the groundwork for advanced features such as patch deployment, software distribution, security policies, and mobile device management.

📌 Deliverables Provided:

- Screenshots of Endpoint Central console.
- Screenshots of Kali and Ubuntu VMs as managed endpoints.
- Screenshots of inventory details.
- This report summarizing steps, results, and challenges.